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1. Introduction

This report analyzes a phishing email incident detected in the organization. The purpose is to identify malicious indicators, assess risk, and document the response process followed by a SOC analyst.

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2. Phishing Email Analysis

The received email shows clear signs of a phishing attack: •

- Sender: security-update@micr0soft-support.com
- Subject: Urgent: Reset your account password now
- Message creates urgency (account suspension warning)
- Generic greeting: *"Dear User"*
- Suspicious link included

These indicate:

- Social engineering
- Impersonation of Microsoft
- Urgency-based attack

From: security-update@micr0soft-support.com
To: employee@company.com
Subject: Urgent: Reset your account password now

Dear User,

Your email account will be suspended today due to unusual activity.

Please click the link below immediately to verify your account:

http://micr0soft-account-reset.com/login

Failure to act may result in permanent account suspension.

Regards,
Security Team

***Figure 1**: Phishing Email Sample*

3. Domain Analysis

The domain provided in the email:
http://micr0soft-account-reset.com/login

Analysis findings:

- Uses typosquatting (0 instead of "o" in Microsoft)
- Not an official Microsoft domain
- Checked in VirusTotal → 0 detections **Important:**

Even though VirusTotal shows no detection, the domain is still suspicious because:

- It mimics a trusted brand
- Newly created phishing domains often bypass detection

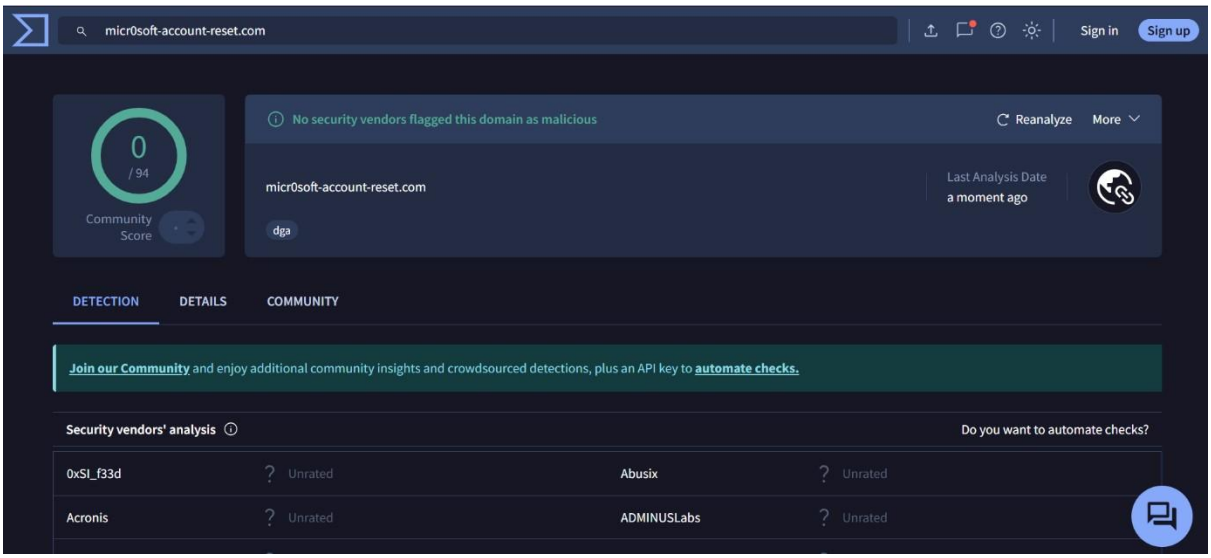

***Figure 2:** VirusTotal Analysis*

4. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

The attack is mapped to MITRE ATT&CK framework:

- Tactic: Initial Access
- Technique: Phishing
- Technique ID: T1566 **Explanation:**

The attacker used a phishing email to trick the user into clicking a malicious

link and potentially stealing credentials. This aligns with MITRE ATT&CK technique T1566.

5. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

- Malicious Domain: micr0soft-account-reset.com
- Sender Email: security-update@micr0soft-support.com
- URL: http://micr0soft-account-reset.com/login

6. Alert Triage

Type	Description	Asset	CVSS	Priority	MITRE	Status
Phishing	Suspicious password reset email detected	User PC	8.0	High	T1566	Open

7. Incident Timeline

Time	Action
10:00 AM	Email received
10:05 AM	Alert generated
10:15 AM	Analysis started
10:30 AM	Domain checked (VirusTotal)
10:45 AM	Alert classified as High

8. Incident Response Steps

1. Identification:
   Phishing email detected with suspicious link.
2. Containment:
   Blocked malicious domain at firewall and email gateway.
3. Eradication:
   Removed phishing email from affected systems.
4. Recovery:
   Verified no user credentials were compromised.
5. Lessons Learned:
   User awareness training required to prevent phishing attacks.

9. Impact Analysis

- Risk of credential theft
- Unauthorized account access
- Possible data breach
- Risk of organizational data compromise

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10. Recommended Actions

- Do not click suspicious links
- Block malicious domains
- Educate users on phishing awareness
- Enable email filtering rules
- Implement multi-factor authentication (MFA)

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11. Conclusion

The phishing email was successfully identified using manual analysis techniques.
Although automated tools like VirusTotal did not detect the domain, behavioral indicators such as urgency, impersonation, and typosquatting confirmed it as malicious.
This demonstrates the importance of human analysis in SOC operations.

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12. Post-Incident Learning

This incident highlights that newly created phishing domains may not be detected by security tools.
Improved user awareness and stronger email filtering mechanisms are necessary to prevent future attacks

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13. References

- https://attack.mitre.org/
- https://www.virustotal.com/
- https://owasp.org/